

38% in Delhi say they won't vote for a candidate outside their religion

VIKRAM SHARMA



**RELIGIOUS AFFILIATION
REMAINS SIGNIFICANT
BUT IT IS NOT VITAL**

queue outside a polling booth; they even know the name of the local *neti*. They are voters but they are not demonstrative about their politics: no rallies please. Still there is no escape from politics—or from the choices it throws up. The choices are invariably awful, but they have not radicalised the Indian youth. They may have refused to buy the demonology of the left-liberal establishment while identifying their ideals, but they themselves don't think politics is an ideal profession, for it is still dominated by the "mediocre" and the "bad".

And let there be some professionalism in politics. Let there be more of the Modis. The majority's choice of Narendra Modi as India's next prime minister says a lot—about the Indian youth as well as the Gujarat chief minister himself. Modi may still be a four-letter word uttered with a shudder in certain political saloons. He may still be a monster assembled in the laboratories of our moral Frankensteins. Modi today is one of Indian politics' most astounding transformations. He is one politician who has made development sexy—and a slogan that can win an election. Modi's lasting victory is that it is no longer a slogan for the moderniser. It's a passion. Gujarat has become the model state because he continues to challenge politics-as-usual. In the poll, he defeats not only the

Knowledge is POWER

Young people know they can rock the vote, which is why they like to know their politics, whether it is the name of their MLA or the frequency of general elections

Do you know the name of your local MP or MLA?

Yes	82
No	16
Don't know/ Can't say	3

All figures in per cent. The figures have been rounded off to the nearest integer.

Mumbai's youth are the most aware. Almost 80 per cent know that the first general elections in India were held in 1951. Indore is next at 59 per cent.

92% know that general elections are held once every five years

Nearly one in every five young Indians does not know that a coalition heads India. Oddly, the level of ignorance is highest in Delhi (38 per cent).

What's your source of information on politics?

TV	94
Newspapers and Magazines	91
Parents	23
Internet	16
Teachers	9

All figures in per cent. Figures don't add up to 100 due to multiple choices.